



Speaker notes

FALLS PREVENTION UPDATE – Key Points For ALL Staff (v3.2 FINAL_final) * PLEASE READ *****

Falls Prevention: Updated Guidance for Inpatient Areas Following Review of Incidents in Q3

Falls prevention update

- Ensure the bed is returned to its lowest height setting unless clinically contraindicated (document the reason)
- Place the call bell within the patient's reach and check they know how to use it
- Ensure the patient has well-fitting non-slip footwear on or readily available
- Check and clear the floor area of trip hazards (cables, spills, equipment, clutter)
- Compliance will be audited monthly



Following a review of inpatient falls incidents and in line with the updated local policy (FP-03 v3.2, see Appendix F section 4.2.1), all clinical staff are reminded that before leaving any patient who has been assessed as being at risk of falls, they should ensure that the bed has been returned to its lowest height setting (unless clinically contraindicated, in which case the reason should be documented), that the call bell is placed within the patient's reach and that they know how to use it, that the patient is wearing well-fitting non-slip footwear or has it readily available, and that the immediate floor area has been checked and cleared of trip hazards such as cables, spills, equipment and clutter. Compliance with this will be audited monthly.

Before you leave the bedside

*What do you **check** before you leave?*

*Would you leave your **mum** like this?*

Four checks

Falls: a whole-team approach

Could you prevent the next fall?

FOUR CHECKS!!!

Bed at lowest height

Call bell within reach

Non-slip footwear on

Floor clear of trip hazards

Bed low

Bell in reach

Footwear on

Floor clear

Bed low

Bed low

Bed low

Bed low

Bed low

Bed lowered (where appropriate)

Bed low · Bell in reach · Footwear on · Floor clear



Floor clear

Floor clear

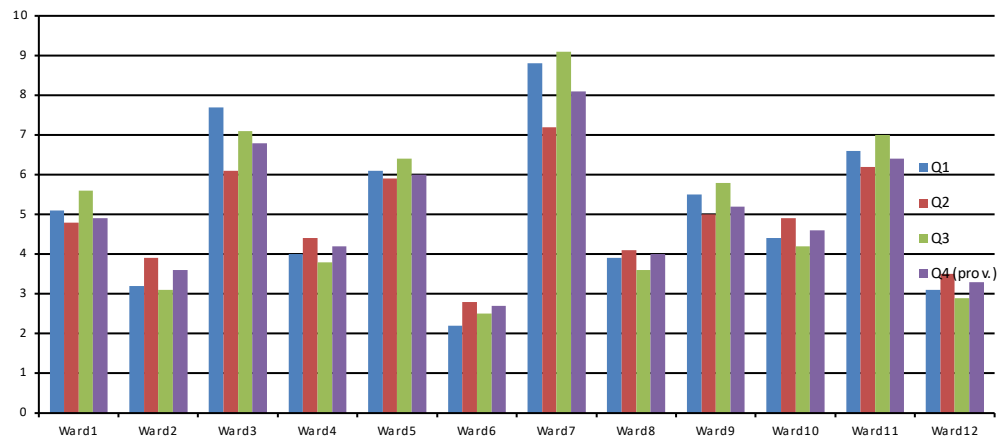
Floor clear

Floor clear

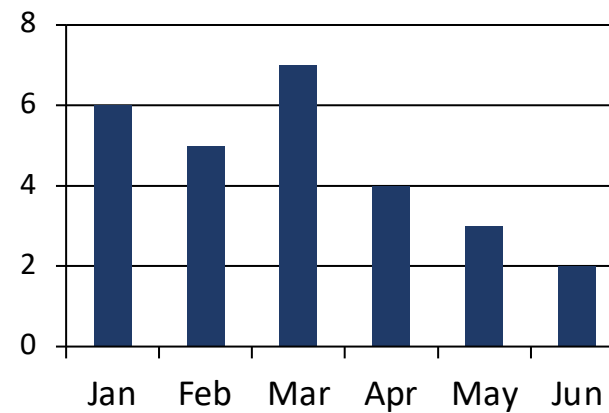
Floor clear



Falls per 1,000 occupied bed days by ward, Q1–Q4 (provisional, excl. Ward 7 March data)



Falls on our ward



2

falls last month

Training compliance is currently **61%**



Teaching That Sticks
Health and Safety Department



***** PLEASE READ *****

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[Click here for the full 47-page policy \(intranet link\)](#)

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Any questions please contact the Falls Lead (ext. 4471)

References: National Falls Guidance (2015); Local Policy FP-03 v3.2; Falls Steering Group minutes (various); Appendix A–K; Form BR-7; Form BR-7a (revised); E-learning FP-201

Remember SAFE: Safety, Assessment, Falls, Environment

Compliance will be audited monthly

Bed low · Bell close · Shoes on · Floor safe

The 4 Bs: Bed, Bell, Boots, Barriers

Check all four before you leave

Before you leave: bed, bell, footwear,
floor, obs, fluids, pain, toileting

● Bed ● Bell ● Footwear ● Floor
(green = done, red = not done)

Around 1 in 3 adults over 65 living
at home fall at least once a year

Unless contraindicated: document why.
Check they can use the bell. Hospital
socks only if they grip.

Credits

Page 2, patient: “Paciente em recuperação da COVID-19 fazendo oxigenoterapia via cânula nasal” by Parzeus, CC BY-SA 4.0.

commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Oxigenoterapia_para_COVID-19_-_São_Borja_23-04-2021.jpg

Page 3, bed: “A Modern Hospital Bed at out-patients clinic in Pok Oi Hospital in Yuen Long, Hong Kong” by Peachyeung316, CC BY-SA 4.0.

commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:A_Modern_Hospital_Bed_in_Pok_Oi_Hospital.jpg

Page 3, bell: “Sonnette de type hôtel ou de table” by Ceridwen~commonswiki, CC BY-SA 4.0. commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Sonnette_1.jpg

Page 3, shoe: “Nike SB Dunk Low Pro shoes” by Jacek Halicki, CC BY-SA 4.0. [commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:2023_Nike_SB_Dunk_Low_Pro_\(3\).jpg](https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:2023_Nike_SB_Dunk_Low_Pro_(3).jpg)

Page 3, ward corridor: “Worcestershire Royal Hospital - 21st century ward” by Chris Allen, CC BY-SA 2.0 (red circle added; this adapted image is CC BY-SA 2.0).

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Page 4, hospital room: “A hospital room with 2 beds in a Danish Hospital” by Tomasz Sienicki, public domain. commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Hospital_room_ubt.jpeg

Page 4, walking frame: “A woman supporting herself with a walking frame” by rawpixel.com, CC0 1.0.

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Page 4, crutches: “A doctor assisting a foot injured boy to walk with crutches” by Awesome Content, free for any purpose.

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